



Android's critical vulnerability

If you're using any Android 4.2 device, or one that sports an even older version of the OS, you're vulnerable. Please read: <http://dgit.in/1f1bqHq>

DIGISOL's i-Trail Real-time GPS Tracker

The i-Trail GPS Vehicle Tracker helps in tracking one's personal vehicle in real time over an online portal with real time map location. It supports apps as well.

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A smartphone has become a necessity for the common man as it not only is a source of entertainment, but has also evolved into the device that allows you to have an identity in this world. Today the smartphone is a mean machine that can play and record HD videos, find places in a matter of seconds, play 3D games with details that were only seen on gaming consoles, connect you to your social network websites and much more.

With that said, we come down the budget category of smartphones. In the past, getting a worthy smartphone meant shelling out a month's worth of earnings but those days are gone. The budget category has evolved to the point that one can now easily get their hands on a quad-core processor powered smartphone and a crisp looking display without having to sell off a kidney.

Indian and international device makers have flooded the market with a number of devices and this leaves the consumer in a bit of a tiff. So to make things a bit easier for you, the consumer, we have carried out an extensive comparison test of some of the best smartphones available under the ₹20,000 price tag.

The Platforms

Android dominates the budget category of smartphones today since a vast number of mobile phone manufacturers have adopted it. Most of the smartphones that we have picked run on Android 4.2 Jelly Bean. Although Google has already launched 4.4.2 KitKat

a number of manufacturers are still working on the update and except for the Moto G, there isn't any budget smartphone in the market running on the latest update. However, we do expect some smartphones in the near future with the new update as Google has confirmed that KitKat will be supported on devices running as low as 512MB RAM.

Microsoft's Windows Phone is growing well, but with the major chunk only going to Nokia smartphones, the number of consumers for Windows Phone are few when compared to Android. The only good thing about the platform is that devices running on WP are not restricted to the high end category. The latest Windows Phone Black update has already arrived on all of the Nokia Lumia devices which again, is a plus point for the platform. The bad news for Windows Phone is that other than Nokia, there isn't any other manufacturer which has shown keen interest in the platform. News has it that Microsoft is trying to

push Samsung, Sony and ZTE to launch a couple of devices every year but whether that can change the numbers for Windows Phone remains to be seen.

BlackBerry is still fighting hard in the market to gain a position; however with the lack of consumers and devices, the new BB OS 10 has failed quite miserably. There are only four devices running on the BB OS 10 platform (Z10, Z30, Q10, Q5), and only the Q5 falls under the category of affordable smartphones. The latest BB OS 10.2.1 update is already out, which now let's you install Android apps by side-loading the installation file on to the device. While this feature sounds exciting, BlackBerry might very well have dug a grave for their BlackBerry World app store.

Under ₹15,000

Perhaps the most crucial segment is under ₹15,000 as a lot of consumers today buy their first smartphone from this section. While one cannot expect really high performance, there are some nice options to consider with exceptionally good hardware. So much so, manufacturers are now offering quad-core processor powered and full HD display equipped smartphones. And it doesn't end there; manufacturers have also upped their game in terms of design and build quality.

So without further ado, let us introduce you to the contenders for the category of smartphones under ₹15,000. For our shootout we have included a good number of phones from a vast assortment of brands, these include the Karbonn Titanium S5 Plus, Motorola's vastly popular Moto G, Xolo Q1000S, Xolo Play, Micromax Canvas Doodle 2, Lenovo S920, iBerry Auxus



Nokia Lumia 720

Nuclea N1, Nokia Lumia 525 and the Nokia Lumia 625.

Design

Available for about ₹10,000, the Titanium S5 Plus from Karbonn is the most affordable handset in the category and it offers a bright 5-inch display with a glossy plastic body. Karbonn has splashed on some chrome to give it a nice feel and the overall finish of the smartphone is actually quite good. Apart from the volume and power/lock keys there are no physical buttons on the smartphone. There is a front and rear camera on the smartphone along with an LED flash.

Motorola has made a comeback in India with the Moto G and has created quite a buzz with units being sold out the same day of the official launch. But does the Moto G offer a sturdy build quality? Well for starters it does sport a crisp 4.5-inch 720p display and nice curvy back that fits well in the hand. The Moto G did feel slightly heavy when compared to other phones, but the overall finish is upright. There are no capacitive buttons so the standard Android navigation



XOLO Q1000S